

HEALTH CARE

Health care courses offer students an opportunity to investigate factors contributing to personal health and, at the same time, gain an introduction to a range of careers in the health care industry. These careers include, but are not limited to, child care worker, dental assistant/dentist, gerontologist, laboratory technician/technologist, doctor, nursing assistant/nurse, pharmacy assistant/pharmacist, and personal support worker. Courses in health care help prepare students for rewarding careers in a sector that is set to expand rapidly as our population ages.

Students will gain hands-on experience using industry-standard instruments, equipment, and materials and practising current techniques. They will learn the professional terminology of the field, acquire transferable problem-solving skills, and expand their communication and interpersonal skills as they interact with their peers and clients in a variety of simulated care scenarios. As they acquire theoretical understanding and practical skills in their areas of interest, students will become better prepared to make informed career choices.

The list of approved emphasis areas for health care can be found at www.edu.gov.on.ca/eng/curriculum/secondary/teched.html.

- Courses in technological education are suitable for use in cooperative education programs and in connection with other forms of experiential learning as well as in programs such as the Specialist High Skills Major (SHSM). For more information, see pages 43–44 of this document.
- For policy guidelines pertaining to multiple-credit courses and emphasis courses, see pages 17–18 of this document.

Child Development and Gerontology, Grade 12

College Preparation

TOJ4C

This course enables students to examine the stages of child development and the aging process. Students will study the processes of disease and factors contributing to health and well-being in early and later life, and will develop skills required to meet the needs of children and older adults (care skills). Students will also learn about legislation governing the care of children and older adults; evaluate social and recreational activities, programs, and services for improving quality of life; and develop an awareness of health and safety issues, environmental and social issues, and career opportunities related to child care and gerontology.

Prerequisite: None

Note: Although this course may be delivered as an emphasis course focusing on *either* child development *or* gerontology (see p. 17), many schools will deliver it as a broad-based course covering both areas, as represented in this document. The expectations that follow outline a full and extensive range of knowledge and skills pertaining to both areas equally, and include distinct examples, wherever possible, for each area. It is recognized that a one-credit course may not afford the time necessary for thorough and complete coverage of all aspects of every expectation for each of the two areas. Teachers delivering the course should use their professional judgement in determining which area will be the focus of learning in connection with selected specific expectations.

A. CHILD DEVELOPMENT AND GERONTOLOGY FUNDAMENTALS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1.** demonstrate an understanding of the stages of child development and of the aging process in older adults;
- A2.** identify common diseases and illnesses that affect children and older adults, and explain how their occurrence or transmission can be prevented;
- A3.** demonstrate an understanding of factors that contribute to the overall health and well-being of children and older adults;
- A4.** describe various community health and social services for children and older adults;
- A5.** describe the final stages of life, grieving, and the ways in which children and older adults may experience loss;
- A6.** identify various forms of abuse to which children and older adults may be subjected, and describe how society tries to prevent abuse and protect its victims.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. Stages of Development and Aging

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1.1** describe and compare theories of child development (*e.g., the theories of Erikson, Freud, Piaget, Vygotsky*);
- A1.2** describe physical and psychological changes associated with the normal aging process in older adults (*e.g., skin and hair changes, slowed tissue repair, reduced mobility, gradual sensory impairment; in some cases, a sense of isolation or diminished self-worth*);
- A1.3** identify and assess common myths and false assumptions about early childhood development and the aging process in older adults (*e.g., an infant brain is poorly developed at birth; older adults are unable to learn new skills*).

A2. Diseases and Illness Prevention

By the end of this course, students will:

- A2.1** identify and describe, on the basis of research, common diseases and illnesses affecting children at different stages of development (*e.g., newborn: thrush; preschool: conjunctivitis;*

school age: chicken pox) and older adults (*e.g., illnesses associated with aging: Alzheimer's disease, arthritis, heart failure, stroke; infectious diseases: pneumonia, influenza*);

- A2.2** demonstrate appropriate hand hygiene techniques and explain the importance of hand washing to prevent disease transmission;
- A2.3** explain the importance of routine hygienic practices to prevent the transmission of disease (*e.g., proper disposal of diapers or incontinence products, changing and handling of bed linens*);
- A2.4** explain the difference between active and passive immunity, and describe how these two types of immunity are acquired;
- A2.5** explain the importance of immunization in preventing the occurrence or spread of disease;
- A2.6** summarize, on the basis of research, the recommended vaccination protocol in Ontario (*e.g., vaccination against measles, mumps, and rubella [MMR]; diphtheria, pertussis, and tetanus [DPT]; influenza; meningitis; pneumococcal infections; varicella*) and explain the pros and cons of immunization programs from various perspectives (*e.g., personal, societal, religious, cultural, legal*).

A3. Health and Well-Being

By the end of this course, students will:

- A3.1** identify the areas of human life and experience that, taken together, determine overall health and well-being (*e.g., physical, psychological, social-emotional, cognitive, spiritual*);
- A3.2** describe Maslow's hierarchy of needs theory and explain how it applies to the well-being of children at different stages of development and of older adults;
- A3.3** explain the benefits of good nutrition and well-balanced meals to overall health and well-being, in relation to age and stage of development;
- A3.4** explain the benefits of exercise to overall health and well-being, in relation to age and stage of development;
- A3.5** explain the importance of social interaction and cognitive stimulation to overall well-being, in relation to age and stage of development (*e.g., to promote cognitive development in young children and to protect against cognitive decline in older adults; to promote a sense of self-worth, connection, and relevance and thus combat depression in older adults*).

A4. Community Health and Social Services

By the end of this course, students will:

- A4.1** describe, on the basis of research, various community and public health programs and services that focus on the physical, psychological, cognitive, spiritual, and/or social well-being of children and older adults (*e.g., day care, early learning centres, Aboriginal Head Start programs, public library programs; elder hostels, senior day programs, Aboriginal elder programs, church programs; in-home services provided through the Ontario Association of Community Care Access Centres*);
- A4.2** describe various products provided through public health services to enhance the quality of life of children and older adults and their families (*e.g., assistive devices, nutritional supplements*).

A5. The Final Stages of Life and the Impact of Loss

By the end of this course, students will:

- A5.1** demonstrate an understanding of the concept of death and describe the five-stage process of coming to terms with death and dying, as conceived by Elisabeth Kübler-Ross (*i.e., denial, anger, bargaining, depression, acceptance*);
- A5.2** describe the physical signs of approaching death (*e.g., decreased circulation, apnea, Cheyne-Stokes respiration*);
- A5.3** describe the clinical indicators of death (*e.g., absent vital signs, fixed and dilated pupils*);
- A5.4** describe some of the different religious and cultural beliefs and practices related to death and dying, the arrangements that typically need to be made in connection with funeral or other ceremonial proceedings, and how financial considerations may affect these practices;
- A5.5** describe various types of loss and how they may be experienced by children at different stages of development and by older adults (*e.g., loss of a pet, separation from a parent as a result of divorce, loss of a body part, loss of peers at an increasing rate in old age*).

A6. Abuse

By the end of this course, students will:

- A6.1** demonstrate an understanding of the various forms of abuse experienced by children and older adults (*e.g., physical, emotional, verbal, financial*);
- A6.2** identify government legislation, regulations, and standards that establish procedures for the prevention of injuries to and neglect of children (*e.g., Child and Family Services Act, Child Protection Standards in Ontario*) and agencies and organizations dedicated to the protection of children's rights and safety (*e.g., Children's Aid Society [CAS], Catholic Children's Aid Society [CCAS]*);
- A6.3** identify organizations dedicated to the prevention of elder abuse and the protection and treatment of its victims (*e.g., Ontario Network for the Prevention of Elder Abuse [ONPEA], Canadian Network for the Prevention of Elder Abuse [CNPEA], Advocacy Centre for the Elderly [ACE]*).

B. CHILD DEVELOPMENT AND GERONTOLOGY SKILLS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.** create appropriate meal plans to enhance the well-being of children and older adults;
- B2.** design appropriate physical activity programs to enhance the well-being of children and older adults;
- B3.** devise approaches to meet the social-emotional and cognitive needs of children and older adults;
- B4.** demonstrate appropriate use of techniques and practices required to assess and meet the physical needs of children and older adults;
- B5.** demonstrate the ability to communicate effectively with children at various stages of development and with older adults when providing health care and/or social services.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. Meeting Nutritional Needs

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** summarize information about the essential nutrients (e.g., *create a chart listing the sources and functions of essential nutrients*) and explain their importance in a balanced diet for children and older adults;
- B1.2** design an appropriate meal plan for a child and an older adult, using relevant resources (e.g., *Eating Well with Canada's Food Guide [2007], Eating Well with Canada's Food Guide: First Nations, Inuit and Métis; cultural adaptations of Canada's Food Guide available from the Ontario Public Health Association*);
- B1.3** design a meal plan that addresses the nutritional needs of clients who have special dietary requirements because of health-related problems (e.g., *heart disease, diabetes, allergies or intolerances*), physical limitations (e.g., *resulting from arthritis*), and/or religious or cultural background.

B2. Meeting the Need for Physical Activity

By the end of this course, students will:

- B2.1** describe the basic components of an appropriate daily physical fitness/activity routine (e.g., *including outdoor play experience, warm-up/cool-down, stretching, cardio [aerobic] exercise, strength training*);

- B2.2** design a safe physical activity or program appropriate to the particular stage of development and/or physical condition of a child and an older adult (e.g., *in terms of activity type and level [tolerance], duration, use of equipment*).

B3. Meeting Cognitive and Social-Emotional Needs

By the end of this course, students will:

- B3.1** describe and conduct a range of appropriate and stimulating activities and games to promote the cognitive and social-emotional well-being of children at various stages of development (e.g., *sort and compare shapes, word games*) and of older adults experiencing various effects of aging (e.g., *sports, baking, book groups, discussion circles in which reminiscence or life review is encouraged*);
- B3.2** evaluate the suitability of a variety of toys, occupational therapy devices, and recreational equipment (e.g., *in terms of appropriate materials, safety of detachable parts, ease of handling, ability to provide sensory stimulation*) for children at various stages of development and for older adults experiencing various effects of aging;
- B3.3** describe and apply appropriate approaches and activities to promote the cognitive and social-emotional well-being of children and older adults with particular health problems (e.g., *impaired vision, physical challenges, hearing loss*), including mental health problems (e.g., *attention deficit disorder, autism spectrum disorders, depression, bipolar disorder, Alzheimer's disease*);

B3.4 select, on the basis of research, and conduct intergenerational activities (e.g., *storytelling, career exploration*) designed to promote the cognitive and social-emotional well-being of both children and older adults.

B4. Care Techniques and Practices

By the end of this course, students will:

B4.1 use correct techniques for taking care of children and older adults (e.g., *when feeding, bathing, lifting and transferring, toileting, and providing skin care such as washing, drying, and applying protective skin products*);

B4.2 demonstrate the correct use of ambulation devices used by children and older adults (e.g., *wheelchairs, walkers, canes*);

B4.3 perform vital sign measurements (i.e., temperature, blood pressure, pulse rate, respiration rate) in children and older adults, and analyse findings in relation to normal values;

B4.4 demonstrate the ability to assess the health and well-being of children and older adults on the basis of case studies or simulations (e.g., *by considering body temperature, skin condition, evidence of bruising, difficulties in ambulation, affect*);

B4.5 demonstrate the correct use of the following: a defibrillator for cardiac arrhythmia; techniques of cardiopulmonary resuscitation (CPR); basic first aid (e.g., *to treat burns, cuts, choking, fever*);

B4.6 demonstrate the correct use of safety devices (e.g., *grab bars, wheelchair, Zimmer frame, high chair, safety gate, car seat*) when caring for children and older adults;

B4.7 demonstrate practices and the use of aids that protect the safety of children and older adults (e.g., *place safety locks on cabinets, cover electrical outlets, remove sharp objects, cover sharp corners and edges, tuck in blind cords, use Velcro closures on shoes, provide non-skid mats, ensure proper lighting, provide appropriately designed cooking utensils for arthritic clients*).

B5. Communication Skills

By the end of this course, students will:

B5.1 demonstrate the ability to communicate effectively with children and older adults, taking their stage of development and/or condition into account (e.g., *use age-appropriate language, compensate for hearing or visual deficits*);

B5.2 recognize and compensate for possible language barriers by using action signs or providing an interpreter, and be aware of cultural differences in communication styles, interpersonal behaviour, and attitudes and customs (e.g., *attitudes towards Western medical treatments and procedures, customs regarding the treatment of children and older adults*).

C. HEALTH CARE, THE ENVIRONMENT, AND SOCIETY

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.** analyse how environmental factors affect children and older adults, and how products and services related to the care of these groups may affect the environment;
- C2.** analyse the role of society in caring for children and the elderly.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Health Care and the Environment

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** analyse the environmental impact of products developed to meet the needs of children and the elderly (*e.g., landfill issues – throw-away toys, batteries, disposable diapers, plastic baby bottles*) and identify more sustainable alternatives with respect to the use of such products;
- C1.2** analyse the impact of a degraded environment and other environmental hazards on children and the elderly (*e.g., increased rates of respiratory problems, detrimental effects of lead paint, effects of environmental estrogens*).

C2. Health Care and Society

By the end of this course, students will:

- C2.1** describe how accessibility issues affect the lives of children and older adults (*e.g., wheelchair access, adapted transportation*);
- C2.2** evaluate the impact of emerging technologies on children and older adults (*e.g., improved design of diapers or incontinence products, new skin care products, video monitoring from a remote site, electronic lifts*) from various perspectives (*e.g., safety, improvement or reduction in quality of life, financial or business implications, opportunities for more effective action for improved health care*);
- C2.3** describe how changing population patterns will affect society (*e.g., decrease in child cohort resulting in excess capacity in schools, increase in elderly cohort resulting in increased demand for different levels of care*).

D. PROFESSIONAL PRACTICE AND CAREER OPPORTUNITIES

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1.** demonstrate an understanding of and comply with laws, regulations, and guidelines related to the health, safety, and care of children and older adults;
- D2.** describe careers in child care, geriatric care, and related fields, as well as the education and/or training requirements for them.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

D1. Health and Safety

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1.1** identify and describe laws, regulations, and guidelines related to the health and safety of children and older adults (*e.g., car seat regulations, Daycare and Nursery Act, senior driver's licence requirements, accessible parking permit, Long Term Care Act, Patient Bill of Rights*);
- D1.2** identify health and safety standards in workplaces involving child care and geriatric care (*e.g., appropriate safety protocols, including clear walkways, proper lighting, immunization requirements*);
- D1.3** identify laws, regulations, and guidelines that relate to various aspects of the lives of children and older adults (*e.g., custody arrangements, living wills/power of attorney, Personal Health Information Act [PHIA], confidentiality and privacy laws*);
- D1.4** identify, on the basis of research, hazards that can affect the safety of children and older adults (*e.g., absence of fire extinguishers and/or fire alarms, lack of information about food or medication allergies, improper household chemical storage, extreme water temperatures*);
- D1.5** explain the importance of proper labelling of hazardous materials (*e.g., to protect against ingestion of hazardous products*).

D2. Career Opportunities

By the end of this course, students will:

- D2.1** research and describe careers in child care (*e.g., Early Childhood Educator*) and gerontology (*e.g., Recreational/Activation Therapist*), and outline related education and training requirements;
- D2.2** research and identify occupations that are concerned with products and services for helping children and older adults (*e.g., video or Internet access to day-care centres, phone access for the hearing impaired, motorized wheelchairs/scooters*);
- D2.3** describe how technological advances have affected employment opportunities in child care and gerontology (*e.g., advances in medical technology such as continuous positive airway pressure [CPAP] respirators, which allow patients to stay at home rather than be hospitalized, have resulted in an increase in home-care jobs*);
- D2.4** demonstrate an understanding of and apply the Essential Skills that are important for success in the health care industry, as identified in the Ontario Skills Passport (*e.g., computer use, data analysis, job task planning and organizing*);
- D2.5** demonstrate an understanding of and apply the work habits that are important for success in the health care industry, as identified in the Ontario Skills Passport (*e.g., teamwork, organization, self-advocacy*);
- D2.6** maintain an up-to-date portfolio that includes pieces of work and other materials that provide evidence of their skills and achievements in child and geriatric care (*e.g., Passport to Safety certificate, reports, assignments, Ontario Skills Passport Work Plan and Transition Plan*), and explain why having a current portfolio is important for career development and advancement.